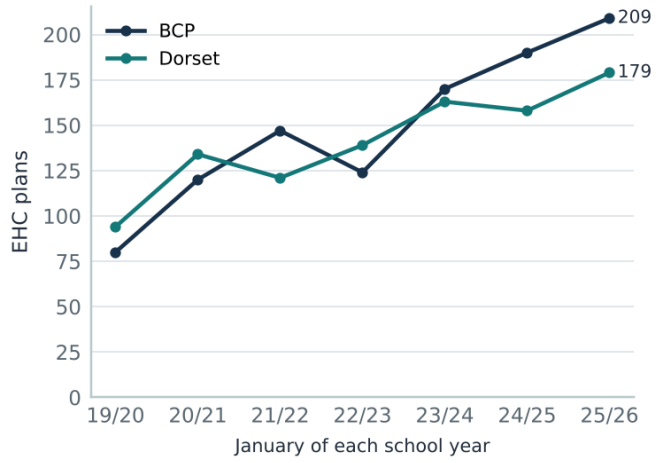
PUBLIC-DATA SNAPSHOT — built only from DfE local authority statistics. No data about SWRAC Specialist College or its learners was used.

Prepared for SWRAC Specialist College — the commissioning picture in BCP and Dorset

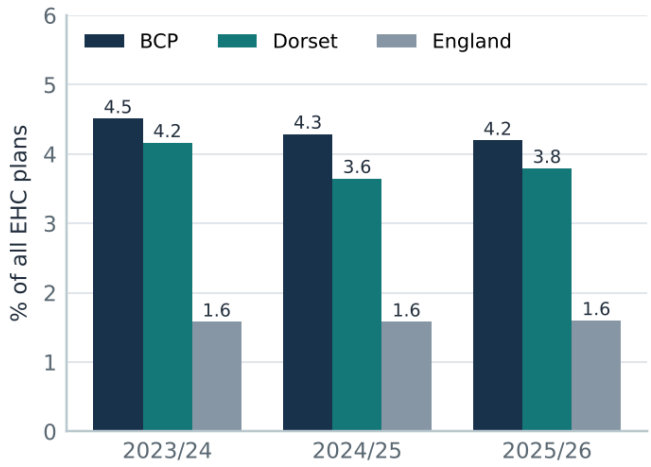
Specialist post-16 placements for learners with EHC plans in Bournemouth, Christchurch and Poole (BCP) and Dorset

4.2% of BCP EHC plans in specialist post-16 institutions, January 2026	**3.8%** the same share in Dorset	**1.6%** England	**388** plans across the two authorities

EHC plans in specialist post-16 institutions



Share of EHC plans in specialist post-16 institutions



Questions this raises — published data only, so these are questions, not conclusions

1. In January 2026, 4.2% of BCP's EHC plans and 3.8% of Dorset's were held by learners in specialist post-16 institutions, more than twice England's 1.6%. With 388 such placements across the two authorities, is each authority's reporting produced once from your own records, or rebuilt for each?
2. EHC plans have grown by 63% in BCP and 46% in Dorset since 2021/22. Annual reviews, attendance and destinations follow every plan. How much staff time goes into preparing them each term?
3. As numbers rise faster than budgets, authorities compare providers on cost and outcomes. Could you show the full cost of a placement, and what it achieves, for each authority you work with?

What a Review would add. Published figures show the demand around you. Your own registers show what each school and authority needs, how long the returns take, and where the figures disagree. A Review maps one recurring report in five working days and shows how to produce it once, checked, for every commissioner. The Reporting & Insight Review is £345, fixed price, no VAT, with a full refund if it doesn't give you at least three improvements you'd act on. Details at **zktheory.org/services**.

Sources: DfE Explore Education Statistics — "Education, health and care plans" (as at January each year, to January 2026) and "Pupil absence in schools in England" (state-funded secondary, to 2024/25), downloaded via the DfE statistics API on 29 October 2026. Local authority figures only; no data about any provider or pupil was used.